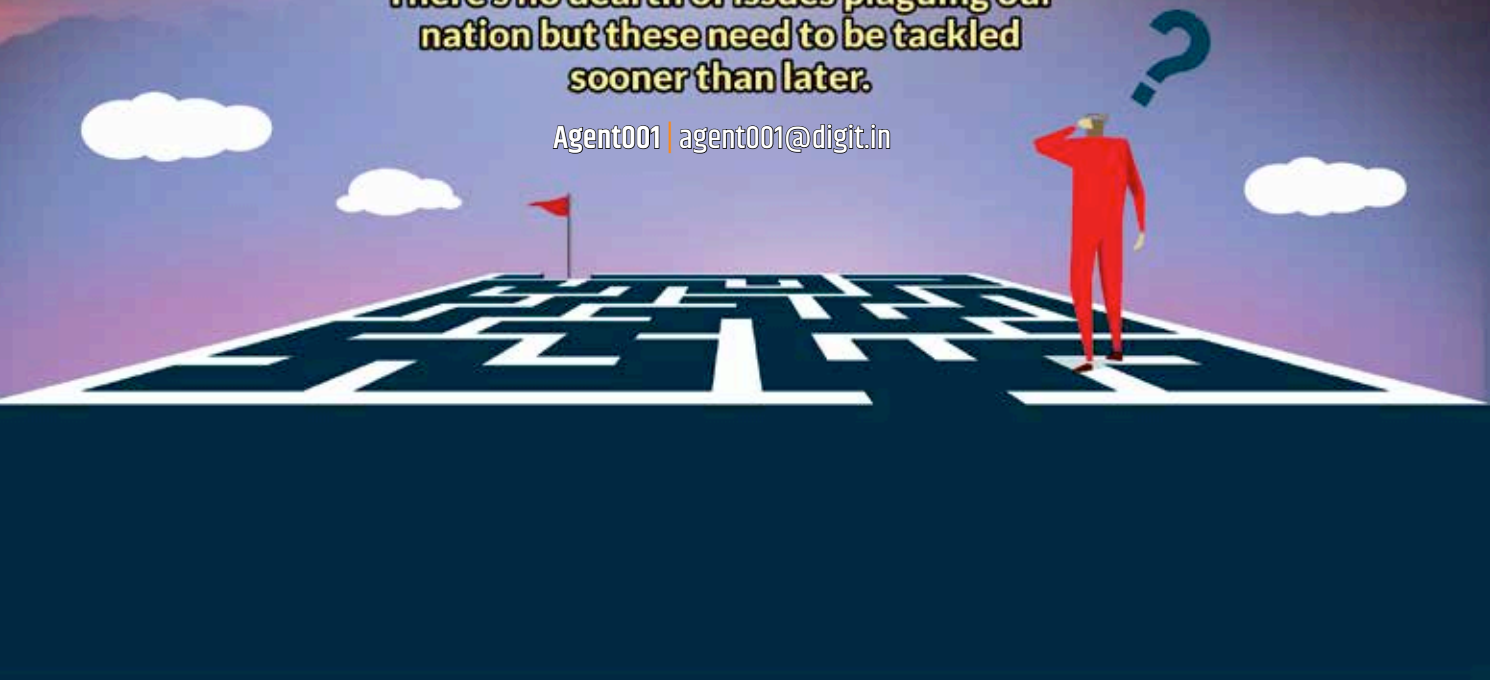


REALITY BITES: HURDLES IN OUR NATION'S PROGRESS

There's no dearth of issues plaguing our nation but these need to be tackled sooner than later.

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India wasn't the only country to have gained Independence from their colonial masters in the 40s. A lot many countries did. India isn't the only country to have undergone an economic reform since its inception, many others have too. Yet we find ourselves asking this question over and over again, "Why are we not in the same league?"

"Why does the brain-drain phenomenon exist?"

SIZING-UP

The answer to this isn't simple and nor are we going to claim ourselves to be the authority on this topic. However, we can certainly pull comparisons and see how we went about our success story and how others did. India is not a failure, that's not what I'm implying at all. Our rate of progress, on the other hand, could

have been way better but before we get into that, we need to find someone to compare ourselves against. Given the length and breadth of India, we need to find similar-sized countries, then there's the fact that a massive population like ours puts immense pressure on the nation's resources. So we need to look at countries with an equally massive population. The last thing would be to see if we both set off from the starting line at the same time. If you haven't figured it yet, then we're hinting at China. Now that we have a benchmark, let's figure out why China raced past us.

PROACTIVE GOVERNMENT

Everyone who's read anything about how the Chinese government deals with an issue knows how stringent they are. While democracy certainly ensures that everyone's voice is heard

but when you have that many stakeholders, decisions take time. When they want something done, they don't take no for an answer. This is extremely effective in nations where the general populace isn't educated. With an educated nation, the US model works way better.

It should be noted that just having an authoritarian government doesn't bode well for the citizens. The government has to be well-intentioned as well. Otherwise, we're simply asking for another dictatorship. Also, none of the Communist nations have managed to progress the way Capitalist nations have. It's a simple matter of running the numbers, the countries with the highest rate of happiness happen to be nations which are capitalist and have driven economic growth using a unitary/federal parliamentary form of governance.